

Coverstory **RANBIR KAPOOR**



"I don't want a chartered plane, diamonds or a big watch. I just get turned on by working on a good movie."

MANDAR DEODHAR/www.indianmagazines.com

recently when he invited Rishi and Neetu to a party at Mannat. A few steps down from the house is the cabana that has witnessed many conversations between his parents, some conducted through the dog Dudley when they were at the height of hostilities, and a copybook garden where a young Ranbir would practice his karate moves. Inside the house, as a pressure cooker lets off steam and his mother's dog, Pagli, whines longingly (her mistress has been in London for

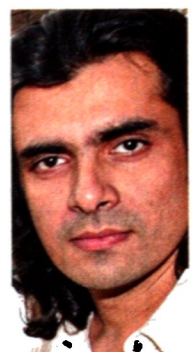
a month), Bollywood's future is talking about his dreams, the visions that come to him when he's staring at the ceiling in his room, whether of a scene from a film, a performance by a contemporary he is jealous about, a strand of hair or even football, a game he is passionate about—a signed T-shirt from Lionel Messi is the subject of much excitement.

It's this boyish enthusiasm that Bollywood will try to bottle and market in its eternal quest for youth.



PRAKASH JHA *Director, Raajneeti*

In *Raajneeti*, we needed a presence people sympathised with and yet the darkness had to come from deep within. We didn't want him to throw himself at the role but just to be.



IMTIAZ ALI *Director, Rock Star*

The dictionary meaning of acting is to do, not think. As an actor, Ranbir is willing to go that distance, to the point where he may actually share the character's emotional turmoil.



AYAN MUKERJI *Director, Wake Up Sid*

He's safe from the pressures of stardom as he is yet to meet his own expectations. His work ethic comes naturally. He doesn't go to work to enjoy the perks of life. For him, work is the perk of life.

It's this spontaneity Bhansali tried to exploit in the towel dance in *Saawariya* where a naked Ranbir pranced about unashamedly. And it's this innate desire to please that made him behave like an energiser bunny in *Ajab Prem ki Ghazab Kahani*. Just three years old in the profession, Ranbir is already more than his pedigree. As his movies get bigger, he has to ensure he remains an actor, not a profit centre, a student of cinema, not a bland toy boy.